warning exercise' meeting remains confidential and no record is maintained on the premise that disclosure of what global policymakers think of as potential threats might actually trigger those threats into materializing!

The Fund–Bank meetings provide a convenient venue for a variety of bilateral meetings. Several people—from global financial institutions, especially large investment banks, think tanks, the academia and the media—seek to meet the Indian authorities. The finance minister and the governor meet them either together or separately depending on the issue and their respective schedules. Running in parallel with the formal meetings is a beehive of intellectual activity—conferences, seminars and panel discussions. The finance minister and the governor of the Reserve Bank are typically featured speakers at some of these events.

BIS Bimonthly Meetings of Governors

The bimonthly meetings of central bank governors convened by the BIS in Basel were among the most productive and interesting that I attended as governor. Set up in 1930, originally to facilitate German World War I reparations, the BIS has had a chequered history, and it has today transformed into a premier organization to serve central banks in their pursuit of monetary and financial stability, to foster international cooperation in those areas and to act as a bank for central banks.

In all the uncertainty surrounding the governor's work and travel schedule, the BIS calendar of meetings was a rare item of certainty. The dates for the six bimonthly meetings every year are determined a year in advance and are not shuffled around. The two-day meetings are typically scheduled on Sunday and Monday with the result that even for those of us who had to take a transcontinental flight, the trip could be managed with an absence from the office of just one workday.

The flagship event in the two-day choc-a-bloc schedule of BIS meetings is the Global Economy Meeting (GEM) convened on Monday mornings, which brings together about thirty governors from advanced and large emerging-market economies to gather around a big circular table—indeed